

LEDGER

Personal Budget & Finance Tracker

User Guide & Feature Checklist

For testers and new users — read this before your first session

What's inside this guide:

01	Dashboard	Your financial summary at a glance
02	Import	Upload CSV files or bank statement PDFs with AI
03	Ledger	Browse, edit, and manage your transaction history
04	Bill Manager	Track recurring bills and plan by paycheck
05	Analytics	Charts and spending breakdowns
06	Rules Engine	Auto-categorize future imports automatically
07	Tester Checklist	Step-by-step feature verification list

OVERVIEW

What is Ledger?

Ledger is a personal finance app designed to give you a clear, real-time picture of where your money goes. It combines bank statement importing, automatic bill tracking, paycheck-based planning, and spending analytics — all in one dark, terminal-style interface built for speed and clarity.

How to Access the App

The app lives at the published URL your tester was sent. Open it in any modern browser (Chrome, Firefox, Edge, Safari). It works on desktop and mobile — no app store download required.

Signing In

- 1 Open the app URL in your browser.
- 2 You will see a sign-in screen. Click "Sign in with Google" and use any Google account.
- 3 Your data is completely private — each account only sees its own transactions and bills.
- 4 Once signed in, you land on the Dashboard.

TIP Your data saves instantly to the cloud. There is no Save button anywhere in the app — every change commits automatically.

Navigating the App

The bottom navigation bar (on mobile) or left sidebar (on desktop) has six icons. Tap any icon to switch between sections:

Dashboard	— Summary of this month's income, spending, and bills
Import	— Upload bank statements to add transactions
Ledger	— Browse and edit all your saved transactions
Bills	— Manage recurring

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SECTION 01 — DASHBOARD

What You See Here

The Dashboard is the first thing you see after signing in. It gives you a real-time snapshot of the current month: total income, total spending, remaining balance, bill status, and a breakdown of where your money went by category.

THE FIVE SUMMARY CARDS

Total Income	All money coming IN this month (paychecks, deposits, etc.)		
Total Spending	All money going OUT this month (expenses you imported)		
Balance	Income minus spending — your net position for the month		
Bills Due	How many recurring bills are still unpaid this month		
Bills Paid	How many recurring bills were paid this month		

SECTION 02 — IMPORT

What Import Does

Import is how you get your bank transactions into the app. You can upload two types of files: a CSV export from your bank, or a PDF/screenshot of your bank statement read by AI. Either way, the result is the same — a list of transactions that you review and confirm before anything gets saved.

METHOD 1 — CSV IMPORT

- 1 Go to Import and make sure "CSV" is selected (left button at the top).
- 2 Click "Select CSV File" and choose the CSV file you downloaded from your bank's website.
- 3 The app reads the file and shows you a preview table of every transaction it found.
- 4 Review each row. The rules engine will have already auto-categorized most of them.
- 5 Each row has an Action dropdown: "Save" (keep it), "Skip" (ignore it), or "Review" (flag it to look at later). Duplicate transactions are automatically highlighted in yellow.
- 6 Click "Confirm Import" when you are happy with the list. Saved transactions go to your Ledger.

TIP Most banks let you download a CSV from your account activity page. Look for 'Export' or 'Download' in your bank's transaction history.

METHOD 2 — AI VISION IMPORT (PDF OR SCREENSHOT)

- 1 Go to Import and select "AI Vision" (right button at the top).
- 2 Click "Upload Statement" and choose a PDF or image file of your bank statement.
- 3 The AI reads the document and extracts both income and expense transactions. This takes 10-20 seconds.
- 4 You see the same preview table as CSV import — review categories, mark actions, then confirm.

TIP AI Vision works on PDFs, JPG, PNG, and HEIC files. If your bank doesn't offer CSV export, take a screenshot of your statement and use this method.

MARKING A TRANSACTION AS A RECURRING BILL DURING IMPORT

This is a powerful shortcut. While reviewing your import, any expense row shows a small "Add Recurring" button below its category dropdown.

- 1 Set a transaction's category to "Bills" (or any expense category).
- 2 Click the small "Add Recurring"

button — it lights up green and says "Recurring".

- 3 When you confirm the import, that transaction automatically creates an entry in your Bills list with the correct name, amount, and due day — no manual entry needed.

A counter in the summary bar shows how many you have marked before you hit confirm. The success message will also tell you how many recurring bills were added.

TIP This is the fastest way to build your bills list. Import a fresh statement, mark each recurring charge, confirm — your bills list fills itself.

MANAGING DUPLICATES

If a transaction was already imported in a previous session, the app flags it in yellow as a 'Potential Duplicate.' You can still save it if you want, but the warning lets you avoid counting something twice.

SECTION 03 — LEDGER

What the Ledger Is

The Ledger is your complete transaction history — every income and expense you have ever imported or manually added, organized by month. Think of it as a digital checkbook register. You can search, filter, edit, and delete any entry from here.

READING THE TRANSACTION LIST

Each row shows: date, transaction name, category badge, amount, and status. Income entries appear with a green + sign. Expenses are plain. Transactions flagged for review show an orange indicator.

FILTERING AND SEARCHING

- 1 Use the search bar at the top to find any transaction by name.
 - 2 Filter by category using the category dropdown to see only Bills, only Fuel, only Shopping, etc.
 - 3 Filter by income vs. expense to separate the two.
 - 4 Switch months using the month selector to view any past month.
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EDITING A TRANSACTION

- 1 Find the transaction you want to change.
 - 2 Click the pencil (edit) icon on that row.
 - 3 A form slides in where you can change the name, amount, date, category, or status.
 - 4 Click "Save" to commit the change. It updates instantly everywhere — the Dashboard totals and Analytics charts both reflect the change immediately.
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DELETING A TRANSACTION

- 1 Click the trash icon on any transaction row.
- 2 Confirm the deletion. The transaction is permanently removed.

TIP Deleting a transaction from the Ledger does NOT affect your Bills list. Bills and transactions are separate — one is your template of recurring charges, the other is your actual imported history.

ADDING A TRANSACTION MANUALLY

If you have a charge that did not show up in your import, you can add it by hand. Look for the "+" or "Add Transaction" button at the top of the Ledger page. Fill in the date, name, amount, and category, then save.

INCOME TRANSACTIONS

When income entries are imported (paychecks, direct deposits, etc.), they get their own income category label — Paycheck, Freelance, Transfer, Other Income, etc. These are counted separately from expenses and feed the 'Total Income' card on the Dashboard.

SECTION 04 — BILL MANAGER

What Bill Manager Is

Bill Manager is your master list of recurring charges — rent, car notes, subscriptions, utilities, medical payments, anything that repeats every month. You set them up once and they appear every month automatically. You never re-enter them.

TIP Bill Manager is NOT your transaction history — it is your bill template. Think of it like a list of bills pinned to your refrigerator that you check off as you pay them each month.

THREE WAYS TO ADD BILLS

Option A — Paste List (Fastest)

If you have a list of all your bills, you can import them all at once.

- 1 Click the "Paste List" button in the header.
- 2 A text box appears. Paste or type your bills in this format:

```
Vehicle:  
03/11 — Wells Fargo Auto Loan: $181.39  
03/23 — Oklahoma Motor Credit: $290.00
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Subscriptions:  
Monthly — Netflix: $7.00  
Monthly — ChatGPT: $21.19
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- 3 Click "Parse Bills." The app reads your list and shows a preview table.
- 4 In the preview, every row is fully editable. Click into any name, amount, or day field to correct it. Click the X on a row to remove a bill you do not want.
- 5 Click "Import All Bills" to save. All bills load at once.

Option B — Mark During Import

When importing a bank statement, click "Add Recurring" on any expense row. On confirm, that transaction automatically creates a bill entry. See the Import section for full details.

Option C — Add Manually

Click the "+" button at the top of Bill Manager. Fill in the name, amount, due day (1–31), category, and whether it is recurring. Save it.

EDITING OR DELETING ANY BILL

Every bill in the list has a pencil icon (edit) and a trash icon (delete).

- 1 Pencil — opens an inline edit form. Change the name, amount, due day, or category. Save when done. The change shows immediately in every month.

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Trash — permanently deletes the bill from your list. It disappears from all future months.

TIP If a bill amount changes — like your phone plan goes up — just edit that bill once. The new amount shows up in the current month and every future month automatically.

MARKING BILLS AS PAID

Each bill row has a circle button on the right side. Tap it to mark that bill as paid for the current month. It shows a green checkmark and the row dims. Tap again to un-mark it.

Paid status is tracked per-month — marking February's rent as paid does not affect March's rent status.

PAYCHECK PLANNER

The Paycheck Planner splits your bills into two groups based on which paycheck covers them — useful if you get paid twice a month.

- 1 Click the "Paycheck" button and enter your two pay days (example: day 6 and day 20).
 - 2 The planner creates two side-by-side panels: Paycheck 1 and Paycheck 2.
 - 3 Each panel shows which bills fall in that window, the total amount, and how much is already paid.
- Bills automatically sort into the correct window based on their due day.
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DETECT — AUTO-FIND RECURRING BILLS

The "Detect" button scans all your imported transaction history and looks for charges that appeared in multiple months on similar dates with similar amounts. These are flagged as likely recurring bills.

- 1 Click "Detect" (the scan icon in the header).
- 2 A list of suggested recurring bills appears. Bills already in your list are marked with a blue badge.
- 3 Check the ones you want to add. Uncheck any you do not want.
- 4 Click "Add Selected" to save them to your bills

list.

TIP Detect works best after you have imported at least two months of statements so it has enough history to find patterns.

SECTION 05 — ANALYTICS

What Analytics Shows

Analytics gives you visual charts and breakdowns of your spending over time. It is read-only — you cannot edit anything here, but it helps you spot trends and understand where your money is going.

SPENDING BY CATEGORY — PIE / BAR CHART

A chart shows what percentage and dollar amount went to each category this month: Bills, Fuel, Medical, Shopping, Subscriptions, etc. Hover over any section to see the exact numbers.

MONTH-OVER-MONTH COMPARISON

A bar chart compares your total income and total spending across the past several months. This helps you see if your spending is trending up or down over time.

SWITCHING MONTHS

Use the same month selector at the top of the page to view analytics for any past month. Each month's data is stored independently.

TIP If a chart looks empty or wrong, make sure you have imported transactions for that month. Analytics can only show data that has been imported — it does not pull from your bank directly.

SECTION 06 — RULES ENGINE

What the Rules Engine Is

The Rules Engine lets you create automatic categorization rules so that future bank imports require less manual work. For example: "Any transaction with 'Planet Fitness' in the name should always be categorized as Bills." Once the rule is saved, every future import applies it automatically.

CREATING A RULE

- 1 Go to the Rules section and click "Add Rule."
 - 2 Set the condition — choose a field (Name, Amount, or Category), an operator (contains, equals, greater than, etc.), and the value to match.
 - 3 Set the action — what should happen when the rule matches? Most commonly: set the category.
 - 4 Set a priority number. Lower numbers run first. If two rules could match the same transaction, the higher priority one wins.
 - 5 Click "Save Rule."
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RULE SANDBOX — TESTING A RULE BEFORE SAVING

The Rule Sandbox is a testing tool. Before you save a rule, you can click "Run Test" to fire the rule against your entire imported transaction history and see exactly which past transactions it would have matched. This lets you verify the rule is working correctly before it affects future imports.

- 1 Build your rule condition and action as you normally would.
 - 2 Click "Run Test" (do not save yet).
 - 3 The app shows a list of every past transaction that this rule would have caught, with the category it would have set.
 - 4 If the results look right, click Save. If not, tweak the condition and test again.
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TIP Rules are non-destructive — they only apply to new imports going forward. They do not retroactively change transactions you have already saved. To fix past transactions, edit them manually in the Ledger.

MANAGING RULES

The rules list shows all your saved rules in priority order. You can toggle any rule on or off without deleting it, edit the condition or action, or delete a rule entirely.

SECTION 07 — TESTER CHECKLIST

How to Use This Checklist

Go through each item in order. Check the box when it works as described. If something does not work, note what happened so it can be reported. You do not need to test everything in one session — this is a guide, not a time limit.

ACCOUNT & ACCESS

- ☐ App loads without errors at the published URL
 - ☐ Sign in with Google works and you land on the Dashboard
 - ☐ Signing out and back in restores your data correctly
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DASHBOARD

- ☐ Dashboard shows Income, Spending, Balance, Bills Due, and Bills Paid cards
 - ☐ Switching months with the month selector updates all card values
 - ☐ Spending by category section appears (may be empty if no transactions imported yet)
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IMPORT — CSV

- ☐ CSV mode is selectable and file picker opens
 - ☐ Uploading a bank CSV shows a preview table of transactions
 - ☐ Category dropdowns work — you can change a category on any row
 - ☐ Action dropdowns work — you can set Save, Skip, or Review on any row
 - ☐ Duplicates are highlighted in yellow when re-importing the same file
 - ☐ Confirm Import saves transactions and redirects to Ledger
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IMPORT — AI VISION

- ☐ AI Vision mode is selectable
 - ☐ Uploading a PDF or screenshot shows the analyzing spinner
 - ☐ After analysis, a preview table appears with extracted transactions
 - ☐ Both income and expense transactions are detected from the statement
 - ☐ "Add Recurring" button appears on expense rows below the category dropdown
 - ☐ Clicking Add Recurring highlights it green
 - ☐ Confirming import with recurring items marked shows a bill count in the success message
 - ☐ Newly marked recurring bills

appear in Bill Manager after
import

LEDGER

- ☐ Imported transactions appear in the Ledger under the correct month
- ☐ Search bar filters the list by name as you type
 - ☐ Category filter dropdown narrows the list correctly
 - ☐ Pencil icon opens an edit form for a transaction
 - ☐ Editing a transaction and saving updates it immediately
 - ☐ Trash icon deletes a transaction after confirmation
 - ☐ Manually adding a transaction with the + button works
 - ☐ Import

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